

2000 - 14

CFO-ORC FILE # 1

COLORADO FIELD ORNITHOLOGISTS - SIGHT RECORD FORM

NEW STATE RECORD _____ UNUSUAL RECORD XRed 1/29/01 vpl

7-0 (A)

Species: White Ibis (*Eudocimus albus*)**Date:** 25 April 2000**Number seen:** one**Sex:** unknown**Plumage:** adult alternate**Locality:** Barr Lake State Park**Elevation:** about 5000'**Nearest town:** Brighton**County:** Adams**Time observed:** late afternoon**Duration of observation:** about 45 minutes**Description:**

White, long-legged wader with a long, decurved red bill. The bird had the same body shape and bill structure as the commonly-occurring White-faced Ibis (*Plegadis chihi*). The obvious differences between this bird and *P. chihi* were the entirely white body, except for the slightly noticeable black wingtips (on folded wing), red facial skin that extended slightly around eye and connected with the bright red bill which became duskier along the distal half, and the bright red legs (dusky red in *P. chihi*). I observed it foraging in a swampy portion of Barr Lake State Park underneath the trees used in the heronry on the SW corner.

Separation from similar species:

There are none outside the chance of an albino individual of another ibis sp. that happened to have retained black wingtips, but the combination of bright red bill and legs is diagnostic for *E. albus*.

Describe the bird's song and call, if given, including method of delivery (i.e. from perch, in flight, duration): None heard.

What is your prior experience with this and similarly-appearing species? I have observed 100's of adult White Ibis while living or birding along the Gulf coast.

Light conditions: overcast, sun low and behind

Optical equipment used: Zeiss 7x42

Distance, and how estimated: estimated closest distance at 170 meters

Other observers who saw the bird with you: Larry Semo, Chris Wood, Tony Leukering, Steve Stachowiak.

Other observers who saw the bird independently: Eric Yesko (initial observer on 17 April), Jennie Duberstein (and CBO education program participants) on 25 April. Lots of others on the following days.

If photographed, type of equipment and film: I did not photograph

List books, illustrations, recordings, other birders, etc. consulted and how this influenced your identification:

a) at time of observation: none

b) after observation: none

Reporting observer: Doug Faulkner

Signature: *Doug Faulkner*

Address: Rocky Mountain Bird Observatory, 14500 Lark Bunting Lane, Brighton, CO 80601

Date report was written: This report was written on 23 August 2000 from memory.